



Handout 6.2: New York Seasonal Chart and Two Meals Task

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

Print pages 1 to 3 for every student. Page 4 is the food picture bank for cut-and-glue and for the grade 6 version. Page 5 is the distance table for the grade 8 stretch.

Part 1. What grows in New York, and when

Key: **F** = fresh from a New York field or greenhouse. **S** = stored from an earlier harvest and still New York grown. **blank** = not available from New York that month.

Food	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Apples	S	S	S	S				F	F	F	F	S
Asparagus					F	F						
Beets	S	S				F	F	F	F	F	F	S
Blueberries						F	F	F				
Broccoli						F	F	F	F	F		
Cabbage	S	S	S			F	F	F	F	F	F	S
Carrots	S	S	S			F	F	F	F	F	F	S
Corn (sweet)							F	F	F			
Cucumbers						F	F	F	F			
Eggs (from NY farms)	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F
Greens (greenhouse)	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F
Lettuce (field)					F	F	F	F	F	F		

Milk and dairy	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F
Mushrooms	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F
Onions	S	S	S				F	F	F	F	F	S
Peaches							F	F	F			
Potatoes	S	S	S	S			F	F	F	F	F	S
Pumpkins and squash	S	S						F	F	F	F	S
Strawberries						F	F					
Tomatoes (field)							F	F	F	F		
Tomatoes (greenhouse)	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F	F

Circle eight foods above and write the season for each here:

Food	Season it is fresh from New York
1.	
2.	
3.	
4.	

5.	
6.	
7.	
8.	

Mark three storage crops on the chart with an S. (A storage crop is picked in the fall and kept in a cool building for months.) Write them here:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

What has to travel to get here? Write four foods that never appear in the chart above, because they cannot grow in New York:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____ 4. _____

Part 2. The four trade-offs of buying local

Write one plus and one minus for buying local in each row. A plus is a reason to do it. A minus is a real cost of doing it.

Trade-off	Plus (a reason to buy local)	Minus (a real cost of buying local)
Cost		
Taste		
Availability		
Jobs		

Food miles means the number of miles a food traveled to reach you. It stands in for the fuel, the trucks, and the days. Write the honest note your teacher said out loud:

Local is not automatically better, because _____

Part 3. Build two meals

Use the chart. Every meal needs a protein, a grain, a vegetable, and a fruit. Label every item with its source: **L** = local (Long Island or close by), **S** = state (New York or a nearby state), **N** = national (somewhere in the United States), **G** = global (another country).

The January meal

Part of the meal	What I chose	Source (L, S, N, G)
Protein		
Grain		
Vegetable		
Fruit		

How many items are local? ____ out of 4

The July meal

Part of the meal	What I chose	Source (L, S, N, G)
Protein		
Grain		
Vegetable		
Fruit		

How many items are local? ____ out of 4

The hardest item to place in January was _____ because

_____.

Part 4. Your decision

Pick one food you actually eat. Would you pay one dollar more for the local version? Answer using all four trade-offs.

My food: _____

Trade-off	My reason
Cost	
Taste	
Availability	
Jobs	

My decision: I **would** / **would not** pay a dollar more, because _____

Exit card

3 foods that grow in New York: _____, _____, _____

2 months when almost nothing grows outside here: _____, _____

1 question I still have about local food: _____

Page 4: Food picture bank

For cut-and-glue and for the grade 6 version. Print, cut apart, and glue into the meal tables instead of writing. Each box has the word and a drawing of the food.

apple	egg	milk	potato
cabbage	carrot	onion	squash
bread	rice	pasta	oatmeal
chicken	beans	cheese	yogurt
tomato	broccoli	lettuce	cucumber
strawberry	blueberry	peach	banana
orange	grapes	corn	mushroom

Page 5: Grade 8 stretch, the distance table

Rough one-way distances to Long Island. Use them to estimate food miles for three items in your January meal.

Food	Where it usually comes from in winter	About how far
Apple (New York)	Hudson Valley or western New York	150 to 350 miles
Potato (New York)	Upstate New York storage	200 to 300 miles
Milk	New York or Pennsylvania dairy	50 to 250 miles
Egg	New York or Pennsylvania farm	50 to 250 miles
Cabbage (New York)	Upstate New York storage	200 to 300 miles
Tomato (winter, field)	Florida	about 1,200 miles
Tomato (winter, greenhouse)	Ontario, Canada or Mexico	500 to 2,500 miles
Lettuce (winter)	California or Arizona	2,300 to 2,800 miles
Strawberry (winter)	California or Mexico	2,500 to 3,000 miles
Banana	Guatemala, Ecuador, or Costa Rica	2,000 to 3,000 miles
Orange	Florida or California	1,200 to 2,800 miles
Rice	Arkansas, Louisiana, or California	1,300 to 2,800 miles
Wheat (for bread flour)	Kansas, North Dakota, or Montana	1,300 to 2,000 miles
Coffee	Brazil, Colombia, or Vietnam	3,000 to 9,000 miles

My three items and their food miles:

1. _____ about _____ miles
2. _____ about _____ miles
3. _____ about _____ miles

The hard question: Name one case where the food that traveled farther is the better environmental choice. Explain the reasoning in two or three sentences.
